

dark side to it which calls for proper attention. At times, you may get puzzled while buying online. News of people being duped while shopping online isn't rare to hear about. In reality, the world of ecommerce is a bit complex. Familiarity to this complicated world will help ensure that you're miles away from turning into a statistic.

The universe of online shopping is ever-evolving. New websites crop up and old ones update themselves to provide better services to customers. The hundreds of online shops spoil you for choice. However, there will be times when after buying the product, you find it unsuitable or unable to meet the standard of quality you were expecting. What do you do in such a situation? And then there's the most confounding aspect of online shopping – the method of payment. You can pay through cash on delivery, net banking, cheque or via third-party payment gateways such as CCAvenue or PayPal. Then there are sites such as Junglee which inconveniently redirect you to third-party sellers' sites – each with its own accepted modes of payment, terms of agreement and sign-up procedures – to make purchases.

While leveraging online shopping facilities, you may be a victim of hacking, phishing, online fraud, identity theft and other attacks. A good number of people are targeted every day. They unknowingly disclose bank account and credit card information which is later used to steal money from their accounts. But don't let all this dissuade you. You can enjoy secure shopping by just following certain guidelines and taking into consideration some advice.

So then, what should you and shouldn't you do while making purchases online? Below is a list of do's and don'ts of ecommerce to make your purchase secure and hassle free.



Image source: vetransilic.com

The Dos

1. **Understand your needs:** You should have a clear idea about your needs and wants of a product before landing on any website. This will help you choose the right website for your preferred product. It would also save